

To the Admissions Committee,

Dear Sir/Madam,

RECOMMENDATION FOR JACKLINE WAMBUI

I am honored to write this recommendation for Jackline Wambui. Jackie is my close friend whom I have known for seven years. We attended the same primary school, were separated by high school and later came together to EaSEP (an organization that helps high achieving low income students apply to universities abroad) Our interaction over the years share experiences which have embodied her as loyal, charismatic, caring, ambitious and fun friend.

Interacting with Jackie is a series of wonderfully unpredictable events. She has this capacity to bring out the most inconspicuous and unexpected aspects of something. one minute you could be listening to a song turned karaoke session, the next she stops the song just to talk about the sense in the lyrics. I always admired how reflective she is because it would always evoke a sense of thought in me which has spilled over to me. She likes to introduce me to music she has stumbled upon on the internet and I have learned to brace myself for questions about the songs various aspects later.

Jackie's company is full of cheer and wonderful surprises. I remember this one time our EaSEP class took an excursion to a nearby river as a means of letting off steam. We were seated by the grass our feet dangling in the cold refreshing water when suddenly she dared to splash water at me. I playfully reciprocated and that was the onset of a fierce water fight amongst all of us. Our until then sedate experience took an unexpected turn that lasted for hours. The memories of hoots of laughter in the air, chasing each other around are vividly etched in my memory. Most of my classmates have declared it the peak of their EaSEP experience reminiscing how our wet clothes clung to our bodies amplifying the normally chilly atmosphere as we walked back to our camp.

Jackie's concern for her mates is an undeniable aspect of her character. At one time, our classmate at EaSEP had gone to town to run errands. It was getting quite late and our friend had neither returned nor given us any communication on his whereabouts. Having had a busy schedule on that particular day, his absence escaped our attention, but that was not the case for Jackie. She drew our attention to the urgency of the matter and took personal initiative to call him several times. It later turned out that he had missed out on cars plying the route hence a delay on his arrival. On Jackie's request, we waited up till he arrived in one piece. Particularly touching was her decisive action in asking the cook to preserve some food for him. This incident spoke volumes of Jackie's caring nature and team spirit.

On hearing her talk, it quickly becomes evident that Jackie is well grounded and quite expressive about her topics of interest. Our sessions at the EaSEP camp encompasses discussions and presentations on various social issues. Jackie's presentation was outstanding given her innate ability to strike a balance between light humor and issues of gravity. She did not rumble through the presentation; she engaged the class posing insightful questions and comments indicative of her mature analysis. Days after her presentation on the Immigration situation at the U.S borders she still sent links to us as a follow up of her presentation. In so doing she went an extra mile surpassing the mere class requirements, portraying the intimacy she employed in all she did.

From a young age, Jackie has an indomitable spirit of service. I owe my stellar performance in my final examination to her personal sacrifice and initiative since she would normally tutor me in my challenging

areas, particularly Mathematics and Science. Even when quite a number of classmates had written me off as an academic failure, she chose to believe in me and aided me through completion of my assignments. Furthermore, at EaSEP, Jackie personally took some students under her wings in the nearby George Mutai Educational Center. She mentored them, doling advice on the best strategies to use in preparation for their final examinations and encouraging them emotionally. The personal connection they had formed lasted to the holidays in which she maintained contact with them. Eventually, they performed quite well in their final examinations and cited her involvement as a major contributing factor.

Jackie's passion for mental health has been the hallmark of her life. She is particularly against the common stereotype that talking about one's issues is a sign of emotional weakness. She believes in the need to create a world where everyone feels that they truly matter and where we can truly hear each other. Her pervasive yet unconscious capacity for listening has seen me resort to her as a confidant. Her welcoming nature makes her very easy to open up to. Her belief in expression is compounded by the blog she established and shared the password to provide an anonymous platform where people can express opinions on the most abstract of issues. In her own small way, she has promoted expression in a society where keeping to oneself is a norm.

Generic adjectives don't suffice to describe a person as unique and accomplished as Jackie. She has had a profound influence in my life. Her natural ambition will see her excel at whatever she sets her mind to. I am thus all in support of any efforts towards the achievement of her dreams.

Yours truly,

Kipngetich Emmanuel